WP-6R-03: Morphine on the renal ward

Example General Hospital, Ward 6R. Version 3 (fictional). Owner: Ward 6R nurse in charge (fictional role).

FICTIONAL TRAINING DOCUMENT. Not clinical guidance. Example General Hospital is fictional.

Scope

Adult inpatients on Ward 6R (renal) prescribed morphine, and any other controlled drug.

Ward 6R local rule

Morphine is not started for a patient with a creatinine clearance below 30 mL/min. Ask the prescriber for an alternative recorded in the prescription.

Controlled drug checks

Two registered nurses check and sign every controlled drug dose, as on every ward.

Monitoring after a dose

Record respiratory rate and sedation score every hour for 6 hours after any morphine dose, because the effect lasts longer when the kidneys clear it slowly.

When to escalate

Respiratory rate below 10 breaths per minute on Ward 6R: stop all opioids and call for help immediately. Naloxone is kept on the Ward 6R emergency trolley.